

19 February 2027 · Porto, Portugal

Business of Class Actions Europe

Europe's boutique forum on collective litigation

80+ ATTENDEES · 1 DAY · PORTO

VIEW PROGRAMME & REGISTER →

BUSINESSOFCONNECTIONS.COM/BOCA27

WORLD OF WINE, VILA NOVA DE GAIA

ABOUT THE CONFERENCE

A focused gathering for Europe's collective redress community

Collective redress is developing quickly across Europe, but not evenly. Some jurisdictions are seeing major claims, active qualified entities and new funding models, while others are still struggling to turn legal frameworks into real cases.

Business of Class Actions brings together the people building, funding, defending and deciding these claims. Through real cases and practical discussion, the conference explores what makes collective litigation work and what businesses, claimants and funders should prepare for next.

1	7	17	80+
FOCUSED DAY	SESSIONS + OPENING KEYNOTE	CONFIRMED SPEAKERS	EXPECTED ATTENDEES

WHAT DELEGATES LEAVE WITH

- Practical insight into how collective claims are built, funded, defended and resolved.
- First-hand perspectives from claimant, defence, judicial, funding and economic experts.
- Meaningful connections across Europe's collective redress community.

WHO YOU'LL MEET

In-house counsel · Claimant and defence lawyers · Qualified entities · Funders and economists · Judges, regulators and academics

KEY THEMES

Collective redress across Europe: activity and barriers	**Cross-border cases: Booking.com, data protection and Essure**	**How qualified entities build claims**
Economic evidence, causation and damages	**Collective settlements and compensation**	**Emerging litigation risks and defence strategies**
What makes a collective action investable		





CONFERENCE VENUE

World of Wine, Vila Nova de Gaia (Porto)

Set in Vila Nova de Gaia's historic wine district, World of Wine overlooks Porto and the Douro.

- Rua do Choupelo 39, Vila Nova de Gaia
- Approximately 25 minutes by taxi from Porto Airport
- 5-minute walk from Jardim do Morro, Metro Line D
- Conference language: English

View venue on Google Maps →

PROGRAMME

PRE-CONFERENCE EVENING

Welcome Reception

Join fellow delegates for an informal evening of Portuguese wine, local flavours and first conversations before the conference begins.

Venue to be confirmed

Thursday, 18 February 2027

18:30 – 21:00

FRIDAY, 19 FEBRUARY 2027

08:30–09:00 **Morning coffee and registration**

09:00–09:05 **Opening remarks**

09:05–09:25 OPENING KEYNOTE

The state of collective redress in Europe

A short comparative overview of where collective redress is developing across Europe and how national systems continue to differ.



MARIA JOSÉ AZAR-BAUD
Paris-Saclay University

09:25–10:10 OPENING PANEL

From legal frameworks to real cases

Why collective actions are becoming established in some jurisdictions while remaining difficult to bring in others, including the role of procedure, funding, standing and court practice.



XANDRA KRAMER
Erasmus University Rotterdam
MODERATOR



ROBBERT-JAN KAMSTRA
Milberg Amsterdam

Additional speakers to be announced

10:10–11:00 CASE DISCUSSION

Cross-border collective actions in practice

A practical look at Booking.com, data protection and Essure claims, focusing on jurisdiction, claimant recruitment, evidence, funding and coordination across countries.



VOLKER SOYEZ
SGP Schneider Geiwitz



PETER HENSE
Spirit Legal



JULIA SUDEROW
Suderow Fernandez

11:00–11:30 **Networking break**

11:30–12:20 PRACTICAL ROUNDTABLE

How qualified entities build claims across borders

How qualified entities select and develop cases involving consumers in different countries, build claimant groups, gather evidence, secure resources and coordinate with lawyers, funders and partner organisations across jurisdictions.



PAUL HITCHINGS
Hitchings & Gonzalez
MODERATOR



CARINE SERON
Euroconsumers



LENA HORNKOHL
Ius Omnibus



PATRICIA SUÁREZ
ASUFIN

12:20–13:10 EXPERT DISCUSSION

The role of economics in collective claims

How economic evidence shapes a claim from the earliest assessment through trial or settlement, including causation, counterfactuals, access to data and the calculation of damages — and how claimant and defence teams approach these questions differently.

Speakers to be announced

13:10–14:05 **Lunch**

PROGRAMME

FRIDAY, 19 FEBRUARY 2027 — AFTERNOON

14:05–14:55 CASE DISCUSSION

Reaching settlement and delivering compensation

How collective settlements are negotiated, funded and approved, and how compensation ultimately reaches claimants in practice.



PORFÍRIO MOREIRA
Sousa Ferro & Associados

Additional speakers to be announced

14:55–15:45 PRACTICAL ROUNDTABLE

Potential litigation risks and how to defend them

The session will focus on product liability, AI, data protection and consumer law, and the practical steps companies can take before claims arise — from documentation and evidence preservation to internal processes and cross-border defence strategy.



STEPHAN KUGLER
Wolf Theiss



SOFIA VAZ SAMPAIO
Morais Leitão



OZAN AKYUREK
Jones Day



GIAN PAOLO COPPOLA
LCA Studio Legale

15:45–16:15 Networking break

16:15–17:05 CLOSING DISCUSSION

What makes a collective action worth funding?

How commercial and impact-driven funders assess collective actions, which risks matter most and why some potentially strong cases still do not receive funding.



IANIKA TZANKOVA
Rubicon Impact & Litigation
MODERATOR



MAROŠ KRAVEC
LitFin

Additional speakers to be announced

17:05–17:15

Closing remarks

A short recap of the main themes from the day and a look ahead at what may come next for collective redress in Europe.

19:00 EVENING

The Porto Evening

Portuguese dinner, live Fado and Port wine in a relaxed atmosphere overlooking Porto. Included in the conference ticket.

Programme and speaker line-up are subject to change.

SPEAKERS

Confirmed Speakers

More speakers to be announced soon.



Maria José Azar-Baud

Associate Professor & International Collective Redress Expert
Paris-Saclay University

- France



Xandra Kramer

Professor of Law
Erasmus University Rotterdam

- Netherlands



Robbert-Jan Kamstra

Managing Partner
Milberg Amsterdam

- Netherlands



Volker Soyez

Partner
SGP Schneider Geiwitz

- Germany



Peter Hense

Partner
Spirit Legal

- Germany



Julia Suderow

Partner
Suderow Fernandez

- Spain



Paul Hitchings

Partner
Hitchings & Gonzalez

- Spain



Carine Seron

Legal Counsel
Euroconsumers

- Belgium



Lena Hornkohl

President
Ius Omnibus

- Portugal



Patricia Suárez Ramírez

President
ASUFIN

- Spain

SPEAKERS



Porfírio Moreira

Partner
Sousa Ferro & Associados

- Portugal



Stephan Kugler

Counsel
Wolf Theiss

- Austria



Sofia Vaz Sampaio

Partner
Morais Leitão

- Portugal



Ozan Akyurek

Partner
Jones Day

- France



Gian Paolo Coppola

Partner
LCA Studio Legale

- Italy



Ianika Tzankova

Head of Global Dispute Resolution & Collective Redress
Rubicon Impact & Litigation

- Netherlands



Maroš Kravec

Partner
LitFin

- Czech Republic

ATTEND BOCA27

Registration





Moments from the 2026 Business of Competition conference in Prague.

Attendance is intentionally limited to maintain a high-quality mix of perspectives. Early Bird pricing available until 30 November 2026. All prices exclude VAT.

ALL TICKETS INCLUDE

Welcome reception, conference catering and the Porto Evening with dinner and live Fado are included in every ticket.

PRICING

PASS TYPE	EARLY BIRD — SAVE 30%	STANDARD RATE
Standard For law firms, economic consultancies, litigation funders, insurers and other industry professionals.	EUR 315	EUR 450
Academia For academics and researchers.	EUR 175	EUR 250
Students & PhD candidates For students and PhD candidates. Limited availability.	EUR 105	EUR 150
In-house Counsel For in-house counsel and corporate legal teams.	EUR 75	EUR 110
Judges, Regulators & Public Authorities For the judiciary, regulators and public bodies.	*Complimentary* By application	

Ready to join us in Porto?

In-house and public-sector rates are available by application to maintain the right balance of perspectives.

REGISTER FOR THE CONFERENCE →

Business of Connections

19 FEBRUARY 2027 · PORTO

Join Us in Porto

Be part of a focused European conversation about how collective actions are built, funded, defended and resolved.

Register for the Conference

Interested in partnering? Request the partnership brochure →



Maria Babenkova

Founder & Conference Director
Business of Connections

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🌐 businessofconnections.com/boca27

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